

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-26

Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; kidney test

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The selection case is the literal organ, not a pun or secondary meaning.

B. Use in sequences

Two short combinations express established phrases:

- Kidney + rock: kidney stone.
- Kidney + test tube: kidney tests or kidney function tests.

MedlinePlus uses kidney stone analysis for a patient collecting a passed stone for a provider or laboratory, and lists kidney tests, kidney function tests, and kidney panel as established names for blood, urine, and imaging checks. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#) and [Kidney Tests](#).

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no Kidney character. Beans is the closest encoded pictograph, and Unicode even includes kidney among its search keywords; however, its CLDR name is beans and it remains a Food & Drink pictograph. Generic medical emoji add care or testing but do not supply the missing literal organ. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

D. Distinctiveness

Kidney is shown as two maroon, inward-facing forms with visible medial notches, a slight vertical offset, and a short central attachment. At 18 pixels, the opposed notches and offset distinguish it from separate Beans and from the symmetric lobes and top-entering airway of Lungs. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomical detail while keeping the paired notched forms, offset, and short central attachment.

E. Expected usage level

Kidney is the necessary noun in several established, unrelated messages. MedlinePlus uses kidney stone, kidney stone analysis, kidney tests, kidney function tests, and kidney panel. NIDDK tells a patient to tell a doctor or nurse they want a kidney transplant and describes donor testing, waiting, surgery, and follow-up. HRSA uses donate a kidney, living donor, and kidney paired donation in guidance for recipients, donors, families, and transplant programs. NIDDK also explains dialysis through the work normally done by healthy kidneys. These uses are documented in [Kidney Stone Analysis](#), [Kidney Tests](#), [Kidney Transplant](#), [Living Donation](#), and [Hemodialysis](#).

The five required frequency exhibits below test the unfiltered term kidney; Google Trends and Google Books compare it with elephant. They establish sustained term visibility, not medical importance or guaranteed emoji use.

Google Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Web Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 211,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Search query.](#)

Google

kidney

×

🔍

AI Mode

All

Images

Videos

Shopping

News

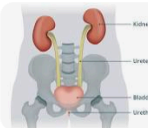
Short videos

More

Tools

Sign in

AI Overview

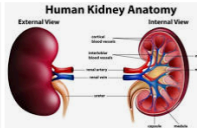


Kidney

Ureter

Bladder

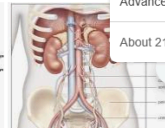
Urethra



Human Kidney Anatomy

External view

Internal view



Kidneys are **two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage.** They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health. [Cleveland Clinic +4](#)

Key Kidney Functions & Health

- Filtration:** Using millions of tiny units called nephrons, kidneys filter waste and excess water from the blood, which then travels to the bladder through ureters.

[Show more](#)

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 211,000,000 results (0.16s)

**Cleveland Clinic**

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease At-a-Glance. Image. 1 in 3 adults in the U.S. are at risk for kidney disease. Image. 90K people...

**National Kidney Foundation**

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

**National Institutes of Health (NIH)**

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

**Cleveland Clinic**

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21824-kidney>

Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health

Nov 5, 2025 — Your kidneys are organs that filter your blood. They remove waste and balance your body's fluids, among other tasks. Most people have one kidney ... [Read more](#)



People also ask

What are the first signs of a kidney problem?

What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?

What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?

What drinks are hardest on the kidneys?

3 of 8

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Video Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 66,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Video Search query.](#)

The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. The search bar contains the word "kidney". Below the search bar, there are tabs for "All Mode", "All", "Images", "News", "Videos" (which is selected), "Shopping", "Books", "More", and "Tools". The search results are displayed in a list format. Each result includes a thumbnail image, a title, a description, and the source. The first result is "How Do Kidneys Work?" from YouTube, Cleveland Clinic, dated Jun 19, 2024. The second result is "Get to Know Your Kidneys" from YouTube, National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK), dated Feb 26, 2024. The third result is "Kidney Function" from YouTube, Nucleus Medical Media, dated Apr 29, 2025. The fourth result is "How Your Kidneys Work" from YouTube, Nucleus Medical Media, dated May 16, 2024. The fifth result is "How kidneys work" from Mayo Clinic, dated Mar 25, 2021. The sixth result is "Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease" from YouTube, Mayo Clinic, dated Dec 16, 2021. On the right side of the search results, there is a filter menu with options: "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". Below the filter menu, it says "About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)".

Google kidney

AI Mode All Images News **Videos** Shopping Books More Tools

www.youtube.com › watch
How Do Kidneys Work?
For more information about the function of kidneys, please
https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3 Your kidneys are your body's cle
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Get to Know Your Kidneys
Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No
matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...
YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases
(NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Kidney Function
KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video
from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025

www.youtube.com › watch
How Your Kidneys Work
MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of
the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024

www.mayoclinic.org › multimedia › vid-20207497
How kidneys work
How kidneys work — Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing
waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.
Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021

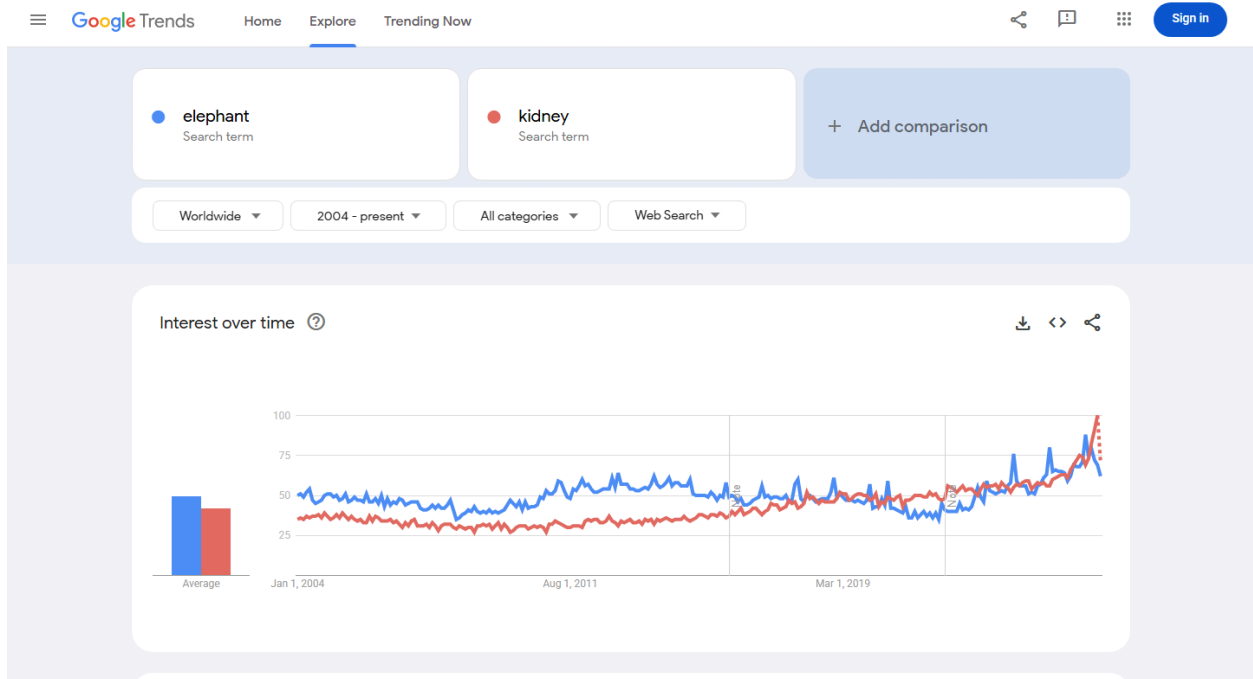
www.youtube.com › watch
Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease
Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you
through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...
YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021

Any duration
Any time
Any quality
All videos
Any source
Advanced Search

About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)

Google Trends - Web Search

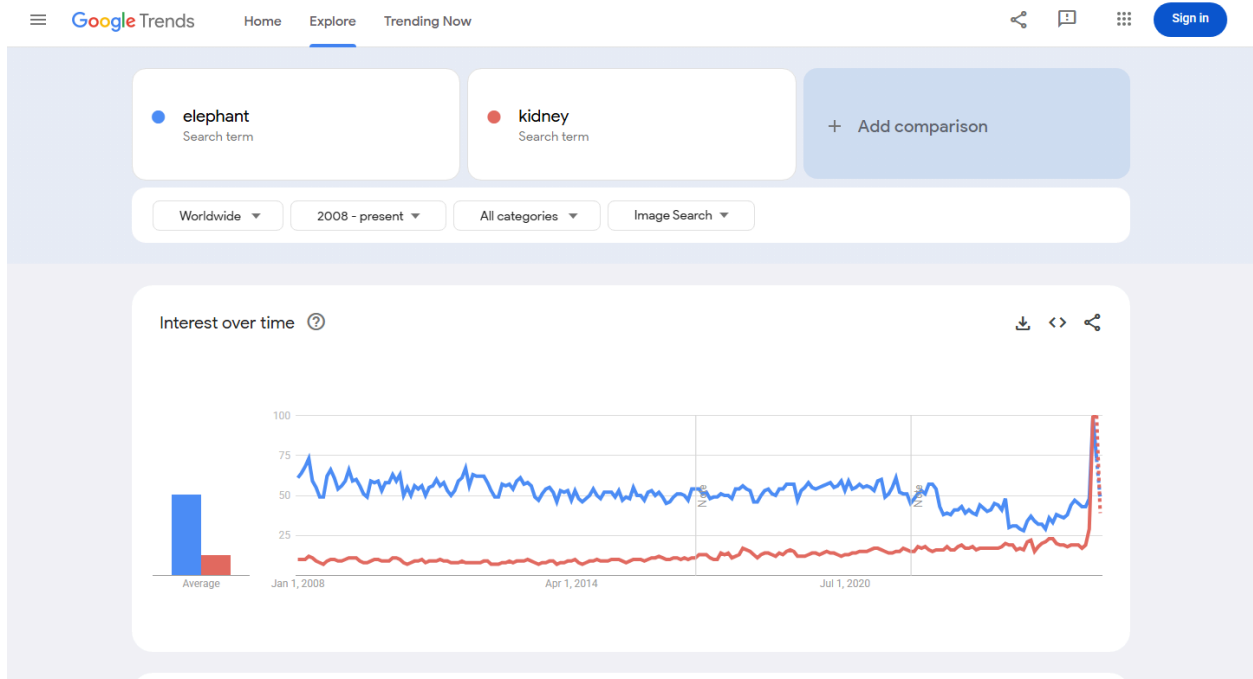
Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Elephant has the higher historical average; kidney remains sustained and reaches comparable or greater interest in recent periods. [Open the reproducible Google Trends Web Search query.](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Kidney shows sustained image-search interest but remains below elephant for most of the displayed range.

[Open the reproducible Google Trends Image Search query.](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query.](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Internal organs are not a fixed set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Beans is the strongest existing single emoji. Unicode's own `kidney` keyword makes it searchable, and with shared context it can stand in for a kidney. Its visible and named meaning is still food. Beans + Hospital can suggest kidney care, but can equally read as food, diet, or beans at a hospital. Beans + Rock does not clearly name `kidney stone`, and Beans + Test Tube does not clearly name `kidney tests`; the reader must first assume that Beans means an organ. A Kidney character supplies that missing noun. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally. The same noun is used in kidney stone analysis, kidney testing, dialysis, transplantation, and living donation; it is not a specific disease, procedure, campaign, organization, or subtype.

C. Open-ended

The closest unencoded neighbors are Liver, Stomach, Pancreas, and Spleen. Kidney is not proposed because organs are important or because an anatomy set should be completed. The bounded rule is that an organ must anchor multiple established messages, remain unidentified by the strongest existing emoji or short sequence, show strong required frequency evidence, and support a stable small-size pictograph. Kidney's specific combination of stone + testing + dialysis + donation/transplant language meets that rule; encoding it would not establish that every neighboring organ does.

D. Transient

Kidney is an established anatomical term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The embedded Google Books evidence spans 1500-2022, while current NIDDK, MedlinePlus, and HRSA guidance uses the same noun across testing, stones, dialysis, transplantation, and donation.

E. Faulty comparison

This proposal does not infer selection from Heart, Lungs, or Brain. Those characters supply only visual comparisons; Kidney is evaluated through its observed messages, Beans substitute gap, frequency evidence, and paired notched pictograph.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney identifies the organ concept even though the example shows the familiar paired organs; this proposal does not request separate singular and plural characters. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomy while preserving two inward-facing notched forms, a visible offset, and a short central attachment. Full vascular anatomy is intentionally omitted for legibility at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>